



MALIAN SECURITY PARTNERSHIPS AND SAHEL STABILITY AFTER KIDAL

Conflict Systems Analysis: Intelligence Assessment

A QAP intelligence assessment of Mali's evolving security partnerships, Russian force posture, JNIM coercive pressure, and central Sahel stability risk.

DOMAIN	PRODUCER	FRAMEWORK	DATE
Conflict Systems Analysis	M. Nuri Shakoor / MNS Consulting	QAP(tm) / OSPREY/ SATs	06 May 2026
CONFIDENCE	CLASSIFICATION	THREAT LEVEL	SCOPE
Moderate	Public / Open Source	HIGH / ESCALATING	Mali / Central Sahel

ANALYTIC SCOPE BOUNDARY

This report covers the current Mali security environment through a 12-month outlook with a 90-day forward monitoring horizon. It uses open-source reporting, official statements, public advisories, NGO reporting, and conflict-risk analysis only. Excluded streams include classified intelligence, private diplomatic communications, unsupported casualty estimates, unverified social-media claims treated as facts, and AI-generated material without verifiable provenance. Overall confidence is moderate because Russian force posture, territorial control around Kidal, and junta decision-making remain only partially observable.

OVERALL RISK	WARNING HORIZON	JNIM EXPANSION RISK	BEHAVIORAL VOLATILITY	AUDITED SOURCES
Severe	90 Days	60-70%	4.3 / 5	18

Produced under the Quanta Analytica Process(tm). All claims are traced to open-source evidence or labelled as analyst inference. No fabricated sources, quotes, or data.

01 // BLUF

Bottom Line Up Front

01	Mali's security partnership model is degrading but not yet collapsed. [ASSESS] The strongest current interpretation is partial failure with adaptive recalibration. Africa Corps' confirmed withdrawal from Kidal is a serious operational and symbolic setback, but Kremlin messaging that Russian forces will remain argues against a verified full Russian abandonment. [1][2]
02	The highest 90-day threat is JNIM coercive influence, not direct seizure of Bamako. [ASSESS] JNIM can undermine state authority through checkpoints, blockade pressure, fuel-route targeting, and local movement control without conventional capital capture. Route access, fuel continuity, and civilian mobility are therefore strategic indicators. [5][10]
03	Kidal's loss matters because it attacks the junta's sovereignty-security narrative. [ASSESS] After France, MINUSMA, and ECOWAS-linked frameworks were politically rejected or exited, the junta's legitimacy depended on proving that national and non-Western security partners could restore control. Kidal now functions as a reputational stressor as much as a battlefield issue. [7][8]
04	Civilian protection and humanitarian access risks are severe. [ASSESS] Blockades, checkpoints, abusive armed actors, and coercive counterinsurgency dynamics will shape the conflict trajectory by affecting movement, livelihoods, displacement, grievance, and local accommodation patterns. [12][13]

02 // KIQS

Key Intelligence Questions

QUES TION ID	INTELLIGENCE QUESTION	LINKS TO
KIQ-1	What verified changes in territorial control, actor presence, operational access, and security-force posture have occurred in northern Mali since the fall of Kidal?	KJ-1, KJ-2, Gap-1
KIQ-2	What evidence supports or refutes the narrative of Russian betrayal versus tactical retreat or repositioning?	KJ-1, KJ-5, ACH
KIQ-3	How have the perceived failures of MINUSMA, France, and ECOWAS shaped junta reliance on non-traditional security partners and sovereignty narratives?	KJ-2, Behavioral
KIQ-4	How likely is expanded JNIM influence across the Mali-Burkina Faso-Niger border regions over the next 90 days?	KJ-3, KJ-6, I&W
KIQ-5	What observable indicators would suggest Mali is attempting to reopen ties with previously curtailed international or regional partners?	Scenarios, Annex B

03 // SNAPSHOT

Situation Snapshot

ELEMENT	CONTENT
WHO	Malian junta / FAMA, Russia's Africa Corps, JNIM, FLA / Azawad separatist actors, AES states, ECOWAS, UN-linked and Western actors, affected civilians and humanitarian organizations.
WHAT	A severe stress test of Mali's transactional security model following Africa Corps' withdrawal from Kidal, coordinated attacks, and Bamako-linked route pressure.
WHERE	Mali, with emphasis on Kidal, Tessalit, Bamako-linked transport corridors, central Mali, and spillover corridors across Mali, Burkina Faso, and Niger.
WHEN	Current baseline as of 06 May 2026, with a 90-day warning period and 12-month strategic outlook.
WHY	The crisis affects regional risk planning, NGO security, humanitarian access, civilian protection, and the credibility of non-Western security partnerships.
HOW	Instability is being transmitted through symbolic territorial reversals, route interdiction, partner ambiguity, command centralization, insider-threat perceptions, and coercive armed-group governance.

04 // KEY JUDGMENTS

Key Judgments

KJ-1 Moderate Confidence	Mali's Russian-backed security model is degrading, not conclusively collapsing. The confirmed Kidal withdrawal, route disruption, coordinated attacks, and internal investigations show severe stress. Continued Kremlin support messaging argues against verified full abandonment. [1][2] <i>Maps to KIQ-1, KIQ-2</i>
KJ-2 Moderate Confidence	Kidal's loss damages the junta's sovereignty-security narrative. Kidal was central to the claim that Mali could restore territorial control after prior international frameworks were rejected or exited. [7][8] <i>Maps to KIQ-3</i>
KJ-3 Moderate- High Confidence	JNIM coercive pressure around routes to Bamako is the most dangerous 90-day threat stream. Checkpoints, blockade pressure, fuel interdiction, and transport disruption can impose psychological and material pressure without direct capital seizure. [5][10] <i>Maps to KIQ-4</i>
KJ-4 Moderate Confidence	Internal cohesion risk is rising inside Mali's security apparatus. Defense leadership shock and investigations into alleged military collaborators create a high-risk command environment where loyalty screening could degrade trust and responsiveness. [3][4] <i>Maps to KIQ-2, KIQ-4</i>
KJ-5 Watch Judgment	The Russian betrayal narrative is weak as fact but strong as behavioral risk. Evidence supports localized withdrawal and continuity messaging. The perception of abandonment could still affect elite trust, public confidence, and partner diversification pressure. [1][17] <i>Maps to KIQ-2</i>
KJ-6 Moderate Confidence	Expanded JNIM influence across the Mali-Burkina Faso-Niger border regions is likely if route pressure persists. The likely form is coercive influence: movement control, taxation, intimidation, selective violence, local accommodation, and propaganda exploitation. [6][14] <i>Maps to KIQ-4</i>
KJ-7 Moderate Confidence	Civilian-protection risk is severe and will shape conflict trajectory. Abuse by armed Islamist groups, state forces, and government-allied foreign fighters, combined with supply-route pressure, may increase displacement, grievance, and survival-based local accommodation. [12][13] <i>Maps to KIQ-4, NGO security implications</i>

Evidence Summary

CATEGORY	CONTENT
WHAT WE KNOW	Africa Corps confirmed withdrawal from Kidal after fighting. [1] The Kremlin stated Russian forces would remain in Mali. [2] Malian authorities are investigating alleged military collaborators. [3] JNIM-linked route pressure affects key Bamako-linked corridors. [5][10]
WHAT WE ASSESS	Mali is entering managed degradation with defensive concentration rather than immediate state collapse. Russia is likely balancing reputational preservation with reduced field exposure. JNIM's most effective leverage is coercive route control, fuel pressure, and fear effects. Insider-threat perception could raise purge, mistrust, and command-friction risks.
WHAT WE DO NOT KNOW	Exact Russian order of battle beyond Kidal. Whether Kidal is stable, contested, or episodically controlled by armed actors. Durability of JNIM-FLA coordination. Internal junta deliberations and civilian perception outside major nodes.

KEY DRIVERS	BINDING CONSTRAINTS
[FACT] Russian-linked withdrawal from Kidal. [FACT] Bamako-linked route interdiction and checkpoint pressure. [INFERENCE] Junta legitimacy strain tied to sovereignty-security framing. [INFERENCE] Elite mistrust and insider-threat perceptions may amplify instability.	Structural: weak state territorial reach and dispersed armed-group mobility. Political: sovereignty narrative limits overt external re-engagement. Resource: route and fuel disruption constrain operations and humanitarian access. Temporal: 90-day trajectory will be shaped by whether blockades normalize or collapse.

WSI SOURCE INDEPENDENCE NOTE <i>Load-bearing judgments draw from five independent source streams: Reuters/AP wire reporting, official institutional records, government travel/security advisories, NGO/human-rights reporting, and analytic conflict trackers. Multiple Reuters items are not counted as independent where they share the same reporting chain. Single-source claims are caveated and downgraded.</i>
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Structured Analytic Tradecraft

Techniques applied: Five-Layer Strategic Cognition Map, Key Assumptions Check, Analysis of Competing Hypotheses, Indicators & Warnings, Scenario Modeling, Risk Matrix, Red-Team Challenge.

Five-Layer Strategic Cognition Map

LAYER	CONTENT
L1 FOUNDATIONS	Actors, routes, territorial nodes, Russian presence, ECOWAS exit, post-MINUSMA environment, and civilian exposure.
L2 MECHANISMS	Kidal reversal, route interdiction, command shock, partner ambiguity, and insider-threat narratives convert stress into instability.
L3 DYNAMICS	Losses drive legitimacy stress. Legitimacy stress drives coercion. Coercion increases grievance and armed-group opportunity.
L4 LEVERAGE	Route security, fuel continuity, narrow investigations, civilian protection, and sovereignty-compatible external coordination.
L5 PARADIGMS	The governing worldview is sovereignty through coercive autonomy, constrained by visible reliance on Russian security support.

Key Assumptions Check

ID	ASSUMPTION	WHY IT MATTERS	RISK IF WRONG	STATUS
A 1	Russian forces remain in Mali beyond Kidal.	Distinguishes full partner collapse from repositioning.	Understates model failure.	Active
A 2	JNIM can sustain route pressure for more than an episodic cycle.	Shapes 90-day coercive influence forecast.	Overstates escalation if checkpoints collapse quickly.	Active
A 3	Junta legitimacy remains tied to sovereignty framing.	Determines whether external re-engagement is politically costly.	Overstates barriers to partner diversification.	Active
A 4	JNIM-FLA coordination remains tactical unless repeated integration appears.	Prevents overstating durable alliance formation.	Could understate threat if joint command emerges.	Unverified
A 5	Civilian accommodation risk rises when state protection and movement access fail.	Shapes humanitarian and behavioral risk logic.	Could overstate armed-group influence if routes normalize.	Active

Analysis of Competing Hypotheses

HYP	EVIDENCE FOR	EVIDENCE AGAINST	DIAG.	VERDICT
H1	Withdrawal from Kidal, route disruption, internal investigations.	Continued Kremlin commitment and no confirmed nationwide collapse.	4	Partially supported.
H2	Russian continuity messaging and possible tactical repositioning.	Setback is too severe to treat as benign realignment.	4	Plausible but incomplete.
H3	Fits withdrawal, continuity messaging, command stress, and route pressure.	Depends on unverified Russian posture outside Kidal.	5	Best supported: partial failure with adaptive recalibration.

HYP	EVIDENCE FOR	EVIDENCE AGAINST	DIAG.	VERDICT
H4	Insurgent offensive may be temporary and overextended.	Route pressure, command shock, and symbolic loss indicate systemic risk.	3	Possible but under-supported.
H5	Kidal withdrawal can be framed as abandonment.	Kremlin continuity messaging and joint-decision framing contradict full betrayal.	4	Weak as fact, strong as perception risk.

Scenario Matrix

SCENARIO	DESCRIPTION	PROBABILITY (90D)
BEST / RECOVERY: Controlled Recalibration	Mali, Russia, and AES partners stabilize immediate pressure, reopen key roads, avoid broad purges, and keep any external coordination framed as technical sovereignty-compatible support.	15-20%
BASE / MOST LIKELY: Managed Degradation	Bamako and Russian partners preserve regime-core nodes while losing reach in contested northern, central, and route-access zones. JNIM sustains intermittent coercive pressure.	45-55%
WORST / FRACTURE: Systemic Security Shock	Blockade pressure, further Russian pullback, repeat attacks on regime-core nodes, broad officer arrests, and additional territorial losses combine into acute national stress.	10-15%

Risk Matrix

RISK EVENT	HORIZON	LIKELI HOOD	IMPACT	SCORE	BAND	CONFIDENCE
Civilian-protection environment worsens	12 months	4.5	4.5	83	SEVERE	Moderate
Bamako-linked route interdiction or fuel disruption persists	90 days	4.0	4.5	80	SEVERE	Moderate-High
NGO / humanitarian access deteriorates	90 days	4.5	4.0	79	SEVERE	Moderate-High
Transactional security model degrades further without full collapse	12 months	4.5	4.0	78	SEVERE	Moderate
Regime cohesion deteriorates through purges or command mistrust	90 days	3.5	4.0	67	HIGH	Moderate
Limited channels with curtailed partners reopen quietly	12 months	2.5	3.5	45	MODERATE	Low-Moderate

Applied Behavioral Tradecraft

RANK	BEHAVIORAL RISK DRIVER
01	Sovereignty Legitimacy Strain [ASSESS] The junta's legitimacy model depends on the claim that Mali can restore sovereignty without France, MINUSMA, or ECOWAS-centered pressure. Kidal's reversal damages that claim. WARNING VALUE: Monitor foreign-plot, betrayal, sabotage, and national-resistance rhetoric.
02	Russian Strategic Ambiguity [ASSESS] Russia is likely preserving enough visibility to avoid abandonment narratives while reducing exposure in high-risk field positions. WARNING VALUE: Monitor Russian visibility outside core nodes and any public reassurance campaign.
03	Insider-Threat Perception [FACT/ASSESS] Authorities are investigating alleged military collaborators. If interpreted through a betrayal lens, this can trigger loyalty screening, purge risk, and risk-averse command behavior. WARNING VALUE: Arrests expanding beyond named suspects into wider command layers.
04	JNIM Coercive Governance [ASSESS] Route checkpoints, blockade pressure, and fuel targeting operate as behavioral pressure mechanisms: fear conditioning, scarcity amplification, and protection-credibility attack. WARNING VALUE: Checkpoints or movement rules persisting for 7+ days.
05	Civilian Survival Bargaining [ASSESS] Civilian accommodation with armed actors should not be treated as ideological support. It may reflect fear, route control, lack of protection alternatives, or survival calculation. WARNING VALUE: Repeated reports of local passage, taxation, or protection arrangements.

Behavioral Falsifiers

CURRENT BEHAVIORAL ASSESSMENT	EVIDENCE THAT WOULD WEAKEN IT
Junta legitimacy depends heavily on sovereignty framing.	Public acceptance of external assistance without sovereignty framing or domestic backlash.
Russia is managing reputational risk through ambiguity.	Verified large-scale reinforcement and sustained joint operations that reverse territorial losses.
Insider-threat perception is increasing cohesion risk.	Narrow, transparent investigations with no broader purge pattern or command arrests.
JNIM is using coercive governance pressure.	Blockades collapse with no attempt to regulate movement, fuel, taxation, or civilian compliance.

Strategic Implications and Recommendations

STAKEHOLDER	IMPLICATION
Regional Risk Planners	Mali should be treated as a central Sahel instability accelerator. A narrowing state footprint would increase pressure on Burkina Faso, Niger, and coastal West African planning.
NGO Security Directors	Route validation, staff movement control, hibernation readiness, fuel continuity, and detention-risk protocols should be immediate priorities.
Humanitarian Coordinators	Access deterioration is likely to be driven by road insecurity, fuel disruption, checkpoints, and localized negotiation requirements.
Policy Analysts	Bamako may need external capacity but cannot easily accept assistance that validates prior France, UN, or ECOWAS frameworks. Re-engagement must be sovereignty-compatible.

Decision Timeline

0-72H IMMEDIATE	Validate all overland movement routes daily. Review fuel reserves, hibernation posture, staff profiles, and checkpoint exposure. Monitor JNIM checkpoints and fuel-route disruption for persistence beyond 7 days.
3-30 DAYS NEAR-TERM	Track Russian visibility beyond Kidal, officer-arrest patterns, route normalization, and local accommodation reports. Prepare relocation or program-suspension decisions if another strategic node is lost or Russian pullback widens.
30-180 DAYS MEDIUM-TERM	Assess whether Mali is entering durable defensive concentration, accelerated territorial erosion, or quiet external recalibration. Maintain regional spillover watch across Mali, Burkina Faso, Niger, and vulnerable southern corridors.

Confidence and Uncertainties

OVERALL CONFIDENCE ASSESSMENT: MODERATE

Confidence is strengthened by corroborated reporting on the Kidal withdrawal, Russian continuity messaging, AP and Reuters reporting on defense leadership shock and internal investigations, official ECOWAS and UN documentation, and consistent humanitarian and human-rights reporting on civilian risk.

Confidence is constrained by limited visibility into Russian order of battle, current Kidal-area control, internal junta deliberations, and local civilian perceptions.

Three Uncertainties That Could Flip the Assessment

FLIP 1	Verified Russian withdrawal from multiple non-Kidal sites would upgrade model-failure likelihood.
FLIP 2	Sustained route normalization for 30 days would downgrade near-term coercive-pressure risk.
FLIP 3	Repeated integrated JNIM-FLA operations would upgrade tactical convergence toward a more durable operational front.

Assumption Failure Drill

ASSUMPTION	FAILURE SIGNAL	CONSEQUENCE
Russian forces remain in Mali beyond Kidal.	Confirmed withdrawal from 2+ additional bases.	Upgrade model-failure probability to high; reassess all KJs dependent on continued Russian presence.
JNIM can sustain route pressure beyond an episodic cycle.	Routes reopen without armed-group interdiction for 30+ days.	Downgrade 90-day coercive-influence forecast; reassess escalation trajectory.

10 // REFERENCES

Source Register and RAPITIS Audit

RAPITIS scale: 0-5 for Reliability, Access, Provenance, Manipulation resistance, Timeliness, Independence, and Specificity. Manipulation is scored as resistance to manipulation: 5 = lower manipulation risk and stronger controls.

#	SOURCE	TYPE	DATE	AVG	BAND	CLAIM USE
1	Reuters: Africa Corps confirms withdrawal from Kidal	Secondary / wire	27 Apr 2026	4.57	Green	Localized Africa Corps withdrawal
2	Reuters: Kremlin says Russian forces will stay	Secondary / wire + official	30 Apr 2026	4.57	Green	Continuity signal
3	Reuters: Mali investigates soldiers over coordinated attacks	Secondary / wire + official	02 May 2026	4.57	Green	Internal cohesion risk
4	AP: Goita assumes defense role after Camara killed	Secondary / wire	04 May 2026	4.57	Green	Command centralization
5	AP: Fruit truck ambush and blockade pressure	Secondary / wire	06 May 2026	4.57	Green	Route interdiction
6	Reuters Graphics: Militants' reach across West Africa	Secondary / wire + data viz	01 May 2026	4.57	Green	Regional spillover
7	UN Security Council Resolution 2690	Primary / official	30 Jun 2023	4.71	Green	MINUSMA baseline
8	ECOWAS: Withdrawal statement	Primary / official	29 Jan 2025	4.86	Green	Formal ECOWAS exit
9	Reuters: ECOWAS formal exit of three junta-led states	Secondary / wire	29 Jan 2025	4.43	Green	Regional realignment
10	UK FCDO Mali travel advice	Primary / gov advisory	Updated May 2026	4.71	Green	Route and travel risk
11	U.S. Department of State Mali travel advisory	Primary / gov advisory	Updated 2026	4.57	Green	High-threat baseline
12	Human Rights Watch: Mali country page	NGO / human-rights	Updated 2026	4.00	Green	Civilian protection
13	Global Centre for the Responsibility to Protect: Central Sahel	NGO / atrocity-risk	16 Mar 2026	3.86	Amber	Siege and civilian-risk context
14	CFR Global Conflict Tracker: Violent Extremism in the Sahel	Analytical tracker	Updated 2026	4.00	Green	Regional context
15	Le Monde: Barkhane withdrawal from Mali	Secondary / major media	16 Aug 2022	3.71	Amber	Historical context
16	AP: Wagner leaving Mali, Africa Corps remains	Secondary / wire	2025	4.43	Green	Wagner to Africa Corps continuity
17	Guardian: Russia claims Africa Corps prevented coup	Secondary / media, contested	28 Apr 2026	3.86	Amber	Narrative environment only
18	Reuters: Mali army claimed capture of Kidal in 2023	Secondary / wire	14 Nov 2023	4.29	Green	2023 Kidal baseline

BAND DISTRIBUTION

Green 15 sources: Reuters, AP, UNSC, ECOWAS, FCDO, U.S. State, HRW, CFR.

Amber 3 sources: Global R2P, Le Monde, Guardian.

Red 0 sources used as evidentiary support.

WSI DETERMINATION

The source base is adequate for moderate-confidence strategic assessment. No Red source supports a Key Judgment. Amber sources are used for context, humanitarian-risk support, or information-environment analysis, not as sole evidence for load-bearing judgments.

Load-Bearing Source Cards

Source 1: Reuters, Africa Corps withdrawal from Kidal

RAPITIS: R5 A4 P5 M4 T5 I4 S5 = 4.57 / Green
ATOMIC CLAIM: Africa Corps confirmed withdrawal from Kidal after fighting.
CLAIM USE: Supports KJ-1, KJ-2, KIQ-1, KIQ-2.
MOM/POP/MOSES/EVE: Russia and Mali have incentives to frame the withdrawal as tactical. Reuters has strong editorial controls. Battlefield access remains constrained. The source corroborates localized withdrawal, not full Russian exit.

Source 2: Reuters, Kremlin continuity statement

RAPITIS: R5 A4 P5 M4 T5 I4 S5 = 4.57 / Green
ATOMIC CLAIM: Kremlin publicly stated Russian forces would remain in Mali.
CLAIM USE: Refutes full abandonment and supports adaptive-recalibration assessment.
MOM/POP/MOSES/EVE: Official messaging may be strategic signaling. Useful for intent, not sufficient to prove operational capacity.

Source 3: Reuters, Mali investigates soldiers

RAPITIS: R5 A4 P5 M4 T5 I4 S5 = 4.57 / Green
ATOMIC CLAIM: Malian authorities are investigating current, former, and dismissed soldiers for alleged involvement in coordinated attacks.
CLAIM USE: Supports cohesion risk, elite mistrust, and purge-risk analysis.
MOM/POP/MOSES/EVE: Official allegations may be politically instrumentalized. The source supports insider-threat perception, not proof of guilt.

Source 5: AP, blockade and route disruption

RAPITIS: R5 A4 P5 M4 T5 I4 S5 = 4.57 / Green
ATOMIC CLAIM: Blockade effects and transport disruption affected routes toward Bamako.
CLAIM USE: Supports KJ-3, humanitarian access risk, and coercive-governance indicators.
MOM/POP/MOSES/EVE: Armed groups may exaggerate reach and government may understate it. AP is reliable, but route conditions remain fluid.

Source 10: UK FCDO Mali travel advice

RAPITIS: R5 A4 P5 M5 T5 I4 S5 = 4.71 / Green
ATOMIC CLAIM: JNIM has implemented blockades on key routes, targeting fuel trucks and enforcing checkpoints.
CLAIM USE: Supports operating-risk baseline and route-warning indicators.
MOM/POP/MOSES/EVE: Government advisories may err on caution. Strong for risk posture, not precise micro-route control.

Source 12: HRW Mali reporting

RAPITIS: R4 A3 P4 M4 T5 I4 S4 = 4.00 / Green
ATOMIC CLAIM: Civilians face abuses by armed Islamist groups, state security forces, and government-allied foreign fighters.
CLAIM USE: Supports civilian-protection, grievance, and behavioral compliance analysis.
MOM/POP/MOSES/EVE: HRW has a human-rights advocacy mission and transparent methods. Strong for civilian-risk context. Case-specific allegations still require validation.

Claim-Level C-D-F Audit

LOAD-BEARING CLAIM	C: CORROBORATION	D: DIAGNOSTICITY	F: FALSIFIABILITY	STATUS
Africa Corps withdrew from Kidal.	4	4	4	Accepted
Russia has not fully abandoned Mali.	3	4	4	Accepted with caveat

LOAD-BEARING CLAIM	C: CORROBORATION	D: DIAGNOSTICITY	F: FALSIFIABILITY	STATUS
JNIM route pressure is strategically significant.	4	4	4	Accepted
Internal cohesion risk is rising.	3	4	4	Accepted with moderate confidence
Kidal carries symbolic legitimacy weight.	3	3	3	Accepted as assessment
Expanded JNIM coercive influence is likely over 90 days.	3	4	4	Estimative judgment
Russian betrayal is factual.	2	3	4	Not accepted as fact
Russian betrayal is a behavioral risk.	4	4	4	Accepted as perception-risk assessment

A // EARLY WARNING

Annex A: Early Warning Indicators

INDICATOR	DIRECTION	CURRENT STATUS	THRESHOLD	CADENCE
JNIM checkpoints persist on key Bamako routes	Escalating	Reported	7+ consecutive days	Daily
Fuel-route interdiction continues	Escalating	Reported / Watch	7-14 days	Daily
Additional northern or central base lost	Watch	Unconfirmed beyond reported losses	Any verified strategic node loss	Daily
Russian pullback beyond Kidal	Watch	Unknown	2+ additional sites	48 hours
Officer arrests widen	Watch	Investigations active	Beyond named suspects into command layers	48 hours
Sovereignty-compatible outreach language appears	Monitor	No strong signal	Technical, regional solidarity, or humanitarian coordination language	Weekly

GREEN // MONITOR	Routes normalize for 30 days, investigations remain narrow, and Russian / Malian operational recovery becomes visible.
AMBER // ACT NOW	Route pressure remains intermittent, Kidal remains unresolved, and command investigations continue without systemic purge.
RED // EMERGENCY	Checkpoints persist 7+ days, fuel interdiction continues, another strategic node is lost, or Russian pullback widens beyond Kidal.

B // INTEL GAPS

Annex B: Priority Intelligence Gaps and Action Thresholds

GAP ID	PRIORITY INTELLIGENCE GAP	WHY IT MATTERS	COLLECTION PATHWAY
Gap-1	Exact Russian / Africa Corps force posture beyond Kidal.	Distinguishes tactical realignment from partner retrenchment.	Credible wire reporting, satellite-visible activity, flight / strike reporting, official statements.
Gap-2	Current Kidal and Tessalit control status.	Determines whether territorial loss is symbolic, durable, or fluid.	Geospatial verification, local reporting, convoy access, administrative activity.
Gap-3	Durability of JNIM-FLA coordination.	Shapes whether threat is tactical convergence or emerging integrated front.	Repeated joint operations, shared messaging, command claims, logistics patterns.
Gap-4	Civilian accommodation patterns along blocked routes.	Indicates whether armed groups are displacing state authority.	NGO access logs, transport unions, local mediation reports, market behavior.
Gap-5	Quiet technical re-engagement with curtailed partners.	Signals policy recalibration without public reversal.	ECOWAS / UN communiques, diplomatic travel, humanitarian coordination mechanisms.

C // SOURCE REGISTER URLS

Annex C: Reference & Sources

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